

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 925

By Stevens

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend Charles A. "Charlie" Trost upon the occasion of his thirty years of service as a Uniform Law Commissioner for the State of Tennessee.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly are pleased to recognize those distinguished citizens whose professional achievements and public service have greatly benefited the citizens of this State; and

WHEREAS, one such noteworthy individual is Charles A. "Charlie" Trost, who has distinguished himself as a professional of the greatest dedication, ability, and integrity; and

WHEREAS, born on January 6, 1938, Charlie Trost served honorably in the United States Army Reserve after enlisting in 1957 and volunteered for active duty in Taipei, Taiwan, during the Second Taiwan Strait Crisis; he later continued his service in the Army Reserve and received an honorable discharge in 1963, having earned the Armed Forces Expeditionary Medal for his participation in military operations abroad; and

WHEREAS, after completing his legal education, Mr. Trost began a distinguished legal career that included service as a law clerk to the Honorable William E. Miller, Chief Judge of the United States District Court for the Middle District of Tennessee, followed by the practice of law in Columbia, Tennessee, where he quickly became known for his dedication to clients and his willingness to provide pro bono legal representation in criminal cases; and

WHEREAS, he also served with distinction on the Tennessee Law Revision Commission, where he chaired the committee responsible for drafting the Tennessee Criminal Code and Code of Criminal Procedure, legislation that helped modernize and strengthen the State's legal framework; and

WHEREAS, Charlie Trost furthered his legal education through graduate study in the New York University School of Law Graduate Tax Program before continuing his career in private practice, ultimately joining the Nashville law firm of Waller Lansden Dortch & Davis, where he served as a partner and later as Senior Counsel and became widely respected for his knowledge of tax law and public finance; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Trost's reputation for legal acumen and public service led to his appointment as Commissioner of Revenue for the State of Tennessee in 2010, during which time he provided steady leadership to the department responsible for the administration of Tennessee's tax laws and the collection of revenues that support essential public services; and

WHEREAS, throughout his distinguished legal career, Charlie Trost has contributed to numerous economic development initiatives that have strengthened Tennessee's economy, providing legal counsel and guidance in connection with projects involving major employers, such as Nissan, Saturn, Bridgestone, and HCA, thereby helping foster job creation and economic growth across the State; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Trost has also been deeply involved in civic and professional organizations, serving in leadership roles with the Maury County Library Board, the Maury County Hospital Board, the Maury County Mental Health Association, the Maury County Bar Association, and other organizations devoted to improving the quality of life for Tennesseans; and

WHEREAS, in recognition of his expertise and integrity, Charlie Trost was appointed by Governor Don Sundquist in 1997 to serve as a Uniform Law Commissioner for the State of Tennessee, becoming a member of the National Conference of Commissioners on Uniform State Laws, now known as the Uniform Law Commission, an organization dedicated to drafting model legislation to promote clarity and uniformity among the states; and

WHEREAS, during his thirty years of service as a Tennessee Uniform Law Commissioner, Mr. Trost has contributed his knowledge and experience to numerous drafting and study committees and has played an important role in shaping legislation that has strengthened the legal systems of Tennessee and other states; and

WHEREAS, among his most notable contributions was his work as Reporter and Drafter for the Revised Uniform Unclaimed Property Act, legislation designed to improve the administration of unclaimed property laws and assist states in returning millions of dollars in unclaimed assets to their rightful owners; and

WHEREAS, through his many years of distinguished service to the legal profession and the people of this State, Charlie Trost has exemplified the highest standards of professionalism, integrity, and public service; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that this General Assembly pause in its deliberations to recognize Mr. Trost for his many contributions to the law and for his exemplary service as a Uniform Law Commissioner for the State of Tennessee; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor and commend Charles A. "Charlie" Trost upon the occasion of his thirty years of distinguished service as a Uniform Law Commissioner for the State of Tennessee and extend to him our best wishes for continued success and happiness in all his future endeavors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.

